漢字

Kanji SRS

User Manual — every feature, screen, and rule

A private, offline Android app that teaches Japanese kanji from JLPT N5 to N3 with spaced repetition: radicals, then kanji, then vocabulary.

App version 0.1.0 · 25 levels · 202 radicals · 612 kanji · 1,564 words
Manual edition: November 2026

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1. Introduction

1.1 What the app is

Kanji SRS is a personal Android app for learning Japanese kanji with a **spaced repetition system** (SRS). You learn a few new items in **lessons**, then the app brings each item back in **reviews** at growing intervals — 4 hours, 8 hours, a day, two days, a week, and so on, up to four months. Every correct answer pushes an item further out; mistakes bring it back sooner. Items you know well eventually **retire** and stop coming back.

Key properties:

- **Fully offline.** All content ships inside the app. Lessons, reviews, and every screen work in airplane mode from the very first launch.
- **Private.** Your progress lives only in a SQLite database on your phone. There is no account, login, server, or tracking.
- **Free and original.** Built from free, openly licensed dictionary data. Every radical name and every mnemonic (memory story) was written from scratch for this app.
- **Reminds you.** Optional local notifications tell you when reviews are waiting, and stay silent during quiet hours.

1.2 What it teaches

The app covers the kanji and vocabulary of the JLPT levels **N5, N4, and N3**, arranged into **25 levels**:

Item type	Count	What you answer
Radical	202	Meaning (the radical's name)
Kanji	612	Meaning and reading
Vocabulary	1,564	Meaning and reading
Total	**2,378**	

Learning flows in a fixed order: you learn the **radicals** (building-block shapes) first, then the **kanji** built from them, then the **words** written with those kanji. Nothing is ever taught before its parts.

1.3 What it does not do (yet)

- No desktop version and no syncing between devices.
- **No backup.** If you uninstall the app, reset your phone, or lose it, your progress is gone. (Planned for when sync arrives.)
- No words written only in kana, no example sentences, no stroke-order animations.
- No JLPT N2 or N1 content.
- Not on the Play Store; it is installed as an APK file.

2. Installing and first launch

2.1 Installing the APK

1. Get the `.apk` file of the app (built with EAS Build, profile `preview`) onto your Android phone — download it from the EAS build page or copy it over USB.
2. Open the file. Android may ask you to allow installs from this source (your browser or file manager). Allow it.
3. Tap **Install**. The app appears as **Kanji SRS** (package `com.edduenas.kanjisrs`).

> **Updating**
> New content and fixes ship as a new APK. Installing it over the old one keeps your progress: the app upgrades its database and refreshes its content on the next launch, and never touches your progress, notes, or settings while doing so.

2.2 What happens on launch

Each time the app starts it shows a splash screen in the page color (light or dark), then:

1. **Prepares the database** — applies any database upgrades. If an upgrade ever fails, a blocking error screen shows the message instead of silently losing data.
2. **Loads content** — if the app's bundled content is newer than what is in the database (always true on first launch), it loads it while a loading screen shows. This can take a moment the first time.
3. **Unlocks what you have earned** — on first launch this unlocks the **35 level 1 radicals** for lessons. On later launches it unlocks anything new content made available, and can even level you up if a new APK added levels while you were on the last one.
4. **Schedules reminders** for the coming days (see chapter 12).

You land on **Home**, with your first lessons ready.

2.3 Your first session, step by step

1. On Home, the **Lessons** card shows **35**. Tap **Start lessons**.
2. Read through 5 radicals (one per page): the shape, its name, and a short story tying the shape to the name. Tap **Next** after each.
3. After the last one, tap **Start quiz** and type each radical's name.
4. When you finish the quiz, Android asks whether the app may send notifications. Choose **Allow** if you want review reminders.
5. Four hours later, those radicals come back as **reviews**.

> **Good rhythm**
> Do reviews whenever they are waiting, and add new lessons only when your review pile is small. Lessons are cheap now but each one creates many future reviews.

3. Core concepts

3.1 Subjects: radicals, kanji, vocabulary

Every item in the app is a **subject**, and every subject has one of three types. Each type has its own color, used everywhere: lesson pages, quiz screens, tiles, and chips.

Type	Color	Example	Questions
Radical — a building-block shape. Its "meaning" is an original name invented for this app.	blue	山 = *three peaks*	Meaning (radical name)
Kanji — a character with meanings and on'yomi / kun'yomi readings.	pink	山 = *mountain*, さん / せん	Meaning + Reading
Vocabulary — a word written with kanji.	purple	山 = *mountain, hill*, やま	Meaning + Reading

A shape can appear as more than one type. In the example above, 山 is a radical (it teaches the *shape*), a kanji (it teaches the *character* and its on'yomi), and a word (it teaches how it is read on its own, やま).

Each subject has one or more **meanings** (one is primary), **readings** (for kanji, each is marked on'yomi or kun'yomi; some are primary), its **components** (a kanji's radicals, or a word's kanji), and two **mnemonics**: a meaning story and a reading story.

How the mnemonics work

- **Radical**: 1–3 sentences linking the shape to its name.
- **Kanji meaning**: a 2–4 sentence story that names *every* radical in the kanji by its radical name and ends on the kanji's meaning.
- **Kanji reading**: links the primary reading to a recurring English **sound hook**. The same reading always uses the same hook across the whole course (for example さん is always "sand").
- **Vocabulary**: explains how the meaning follows from the kanji and which reading is used, including sound changes (rendaku) and irregular readings.

> **Example: kanji 山 (mountain)**
> Meaning: "Three peaks rise from one wide base against the sky. Put them together and you have a mountain."
> Reading: "At the foot of the mountain the ground turns to soft sand. Sand sounds like さん. It is also read せん, and やま on its own."

3.2 Levels

Content is packed into **25 levels**. Kanji are ordered N5 first, then N4, then N3, and within each JLPT group by how common they are; each level holds about 25 kanji. Each radical sits in the level of the first kanji that uses it, and each word sits in the level of its newest kanji. Inside a level, items go radicals → kanji → vocabulary.

You have a **current level**, starting at 1. Only items at or below your current level can unlock.

3.3 SRS stages

Every unlocked item sits at a **stage**. Each stage has a name, a color, and the wait until the next review. The app uses its own stage names:

Stage	Name	Group (color)	Next review after
—	Locked	Locked	not unlocked yet
0	Lesson	Lesson	waiting in the lesson queue
1	Seed 1	Seed	4 hours
2	Seed 2		8 hours
3	Seed 3		1 day
4	Seed 4		2 days
5	Sprout 1	Sprout	1 week
6	Sprout 2		2 weeks
7	Bloom	Bloom	1 month (30 days)
8	Harvest	Harvest	4 months (120 days)
9	Retired	Retired	never — done for good

An item is **passed** once it reaches stage 5 (Sprout 1). Passing is what unlocks the next items.

Review times are **rounded down to the start of the hour**. If you finish a lesson at 14:37, the item is due at 18:00, not 18:37. That way reviews arrive in tidy hourly batches.

3.4 Unlocking and leveling up

- **Radicals** unlock as soon as their level is reached.
- A **kanji** unlocks when **all** of its radicals are passed (stage 5+), and its level is at or below your current level.
- A **word** unlocks when **all** of its kanji are passed, and its level is at or below your current level.
- **Level up**: when at least **90%** of your current level's kanji are passed, your level goes up by one, and the new level's radicals unlock (plus any of its kanji whose radicals you already passed). Example: with 25 kanji, 23 passed levels you up; 22 does not. Vocabulary does not count toward level up.

Unlocking is checked after every single review you complete and on every app launch, so new lessons appear the moment you earn them. Newly unlocked items go to stage 0 and wait in the **lesson queue**.

> **Lesson order**
> Lessons always come lowest level first, then radicals, kanji, vocabulary, then content order. After a level up, the previous level's leftover words come before the new level's radicals.

4. Finding your way around

The app has a pink app bar at the top and three tabs at the bottom:

Tab	Title in app bar	Purpose
Home	Kanji SRS	Your dashboard: start lessons and reviews, see what is coming, track level and stage progress.
Levels	Levels	Browse all 25 levels and every item in them, colored by stage.
Settings	Settings	Lesson batch size, reminders, skip ahead, reset, credits.

Other screens open on top of the tabs, with a back arrow in the app bar:

- **Lessons** and **Lesson quiz** — from Home's Lessons card.
- **Reviews** — from Home's Reviews card or a reminder notification.
- **Item page** — tap any item chip or tile anywhere in the app.
- **Level page** — tap a level row on the Levels tab.
- **Credits** — from Settings → About.

Every screen reloads its numbers each time you come back to it, so what you see is always current.

5. Home (the dashboard)

Home opens with the heading **Today** and the line "Learn new items in lessons, then keep them fresh with reviews." Below are five cards.

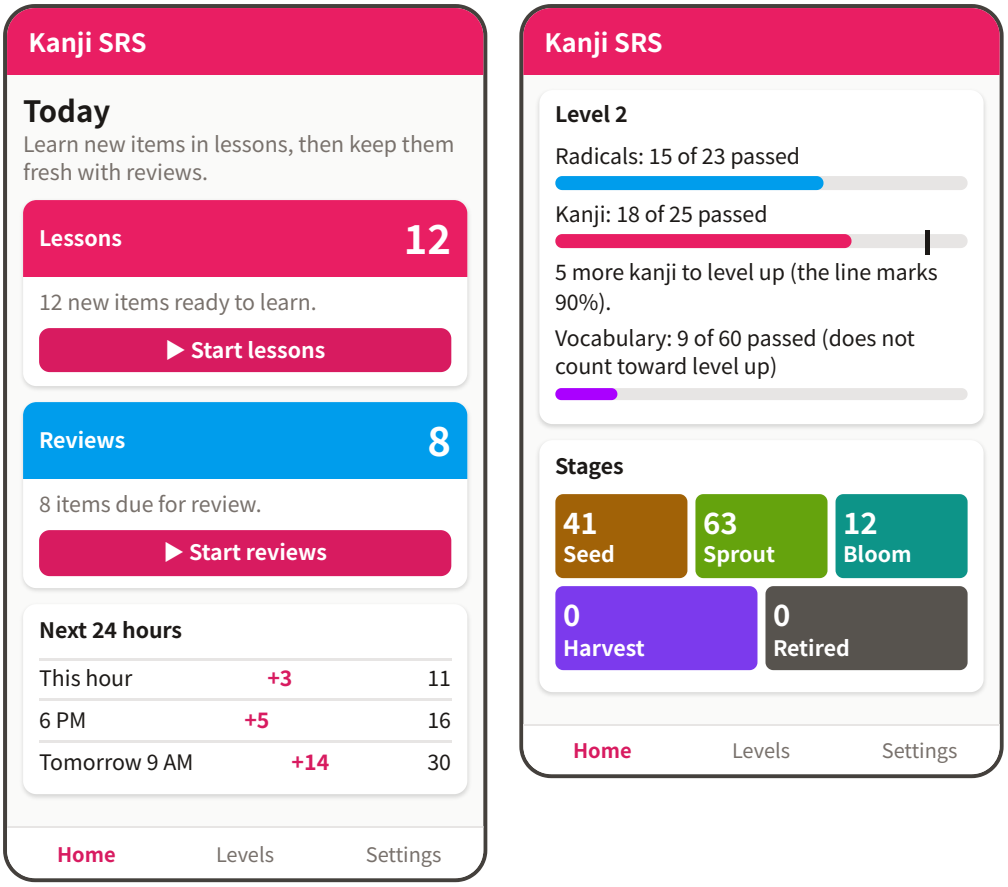


Figure 5.1 — Home, scrolled to the top (left) and further down (right). Illustration; numbers are examples.

Lessons card (pink)

Shows how many items are waiting in the lesson queue (stage 0). Tap **Start lessons** to begin a batch. With nothing waiting it reads "No new items right now." and the button is disabled.

Reviews card (blue)

Shows how many items are due right now. Tap **Start reviews**. With nothing due it reads "Nothing is due. Reviews appear as items come due." and the button is disabled.

Next 24 hours

A forecast of reviews coming due, one row per local clock hour that has any. Each row shows the hour (for example "This hour", "6 PM", "Tomorrow 9 AM"), **+N** new reviews arriving then, and a **running total** that starts from what is due now. Hours with nothing arriving are hidden. If nothing comes due, the card says "No reviews in the next 24 hours."

Level N

Progress through your current level, as three colored bars:

- **Radicals**: passed of total.

- **Kanji**: passed of total, with a line marking 90%. A sentence says how many more kanji you need — "5 more kanji to level up (the line marks 90%)." or "Enough kanji passed to level up." This sentence is hidden on the highest level.
- **Vocabulary**: passed of total, labeled "(does not count toward level up)".

Stages

Five colored tiles with how many of your items sit in each stage group: **Seed** (stages 1–4), **Sprout** (5–6), **Bloom** (7), **Harvest** (8), and **Retired** (9). Zero counts still show. Items waiting for a lesson are not counted here.

> **If Home cannot load**
> A card "Dashboard could not load" shows the error and a `Try again` button.

6. Lessons

A lesson session teaches a **batch** of new items (5 by default; change it in Settings, 3–20), then quizzes you on them. Items come in lesson order (section 3.4).

6.1 Lesson pages

Each item gets its own page, in its type color, showing:

- The **characters**, large.
- **Meanings**: the primary meaning, then "Also accepted" meanings — followed by any synonyms you added yourself.
- **Readings** (kanji and words): primary readings are highlighted; for kanji each is labeled on'yomi or kun'yomi.
- For words, a **Play** button that speaks the reading aloud (only if your phone has a Japanese text-to-speech voice; see 9.6).
- The **meaning mnemonic** and the **reading mnemonic**, with your own meaning and reading notes under them, if you wrote any.
- **"Radicals in this kanji"** or **"Kanji in this word"**: the components with their meanings.

Use `Next` and `Back` to move between pages. On the last page the button reads `Start quiz`.

You can leave freely while reading the pages — nothing is saved or lost, and the items stay in your lesson queue.

6.2 The lesson quiz

The quiz (titled **Lesson quiz**) asks the meaning of every item in the batch, and the reading of every kanji and word, all shuffled together. It works exactly like a review (chapter 7 and 8) with these differences:

- The whole batch is in play at once.
- A wrong answer just sends that question to the back of the queue — there is no penalty.
- The moment you answer all of an item's questions correctly, it is saved: the item moves to **Seed 1** and is due for its first review **4 hours later** (rounded down to the hour).
- Nothing is written to your review history.

When the quiz ends a **"Done, N items"** card appears: "Your progress is saved. Each item comes back for review when it is due." with a Home button.

With no items in the queue, the Lessons screen says "No lessons right now — New items unlock as you pass reviews. Check back after your next review session."

> **Notification permission**
> After your first finished lesson session, Android asks once whether the app may show notifications. You can change your mind later in Settings.

7. Reviews

A review session tests every item that is due (stages 1–8 whose review time has arrived). Each item has a **meaning** question, plus a **reading** question for kanji and words.

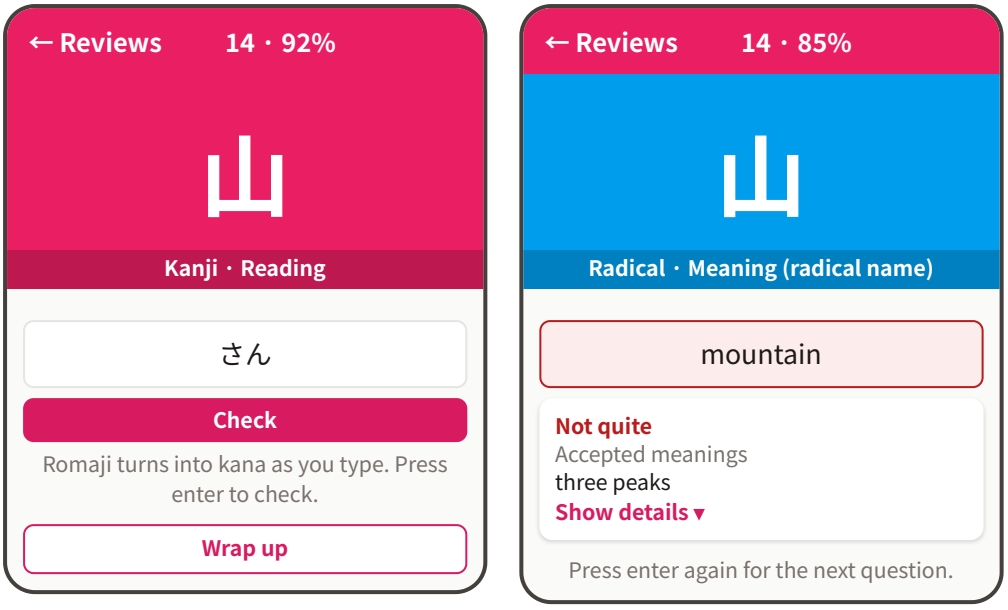


Figure 7.1 — A reading question (left) and a wrong meaning answer with the accepted answers (right). The header shows items remaining and accuracy.

7.1 How a session flows

- All due items are loaded and shuffled. **10 items are in play** at a time; their questions are mixed together.
- Each question shows the characters large on a band in the type color, a label (**Meaning**, **Meaning (radical name)**, or **Reading**), and the item's type.
- Type your answer and press the keyboard's **enter** key (or `Check`). Press enter **again** to go to the next question.
- A **wrong** answer turns the field red, shows "Not quite" with the accepted answers, and sends that question to the end of the queue. Every wrong submission is counted.
- An item is **complete** once all its questions have been answered correctly. It is saved right then, it leaves play, and the next waiting item joins with its questions placed randomly among those pending.

The header

The header shows the **number of items not yet completed** (in play plus waiting) and your **accuracy** as a whole percent, rounded down so that 100% always means no misses. Accuracy = questions whose first answer was right ÷ questions answered at least once. It appears after your first answer.

Show details

Under a wrong answer, `Show details` reveals the mnemonic for that kind of question (meaning or reading) and your own note for it. It is collapsed for each new question and hidden if there is neither a mnemonic nor a note.

7.2 How your stage changes

When an item is completed, the app counts all wrong answers for it (meaning + reading) and moves its stage:

- **No mistakes**: up one stage (to a maximum of 9, Retired).
- **Any mistakes**: down by `ceil(wrong ÷ 2) × penalty`, where the penalty is **2** if the item was at Sprout or higher (stage 5+), else **1**. It never drops below Seed 1.

Before	Wrong answers	Calculation	After
Seed 2 (2)	0	2 + 1	Seed 3 (3)
Seed 4 (4)	1	4 − ceil(1/2)×1 = 4 − 1	Seed 3 (3)
Seed 3 (3)	3	3 − ceil(3/2)×1 = 3 − 2	Seed 1 (1)
Sprout 2 (6)	1	6 − ceil(1/2)×2 = 6 − 2	Seed 4 (4)
Harvest (8)	4	8 − ceil(4/2)×2 = 8 − 4	Seed 4 (4)
Seed 1 (1)	2	max(1, 1 − 1)	Seed 1 (1)

The next review is set to now + the new stage's interval, rounded down to the hour. The first time an item reaches Sprout 1 it is marked **passed**; at stage 9 it is marked **retired**. Every completed review is logged in your history, and unlocks/level up are checked right away in the same save.

7.3 Wrap up and Keep going

While items are still waiting to join, a **Wrap up** button sits below the answer button. Tap it to stop new items joining: you finish only the items already in play, and the header count shows just those. The button then reads **Keep going**, which refills play back to 10 at once. Items that never joined are untouched and stay due.

7.4 Leaving a session

If you press Android's back button or the app bar arrow after answering at least one question, a dialog asks **"Leave this session?"** — "Items you finished are saved. Items you were partway through are not, and will be waiting next time." Choose **Keep going** to stay or confirm to leave. This applies to reviews and to the lesson quiz.

7.5 The session summary

When the session ends, a summary titled **"Done, N items"** shows:

- How many items were **correct** (no misses) and **incorrect**, and your **accuracy**.
- A **"Level N is open"** banner if you leveled up during the session.
- **"N new lessons unlocked"** if your reviews unlocked anything.
- Two lists, **Correct** and **Incorrect**, with each item as a chip and its stage change, e.g. "Seed 4 → Sprout 1".

- Buttons: always **Home**; plus **Start lessons** if lessons are waiting and **Keep reviewing** if more reviews are due, each with its count.

With nothing due, the Reviews screen says "No reviews right now — Everything is up to date."

> **If a save fails**
> A toast says the item could not be saved; that item is dropped from the session (it stays due) and the session carries on. Nothing half-written is ever stored.

8. How answers are checked

The app is forgiving where it is safe to be, and strict where it matters.

8.1 Possible results

Result	What you see	Counts as
Correct	Field turns green.	Right
Close enough	Field turns green; "Close enough" and "Answer: <the expected meaning>".	Right (everywhere: queue, accuracy, stage)
Wrong	Field turns red; "Not quite" and the accepted answers.	Wrong
Wrong kind (kanji reading)	Field shakes; "Looking for the on'yomi" (or kun'yomi).	**Does not count** — try again
Invalid	Field shakes; "Type the reading in kana" or "Type the meaning in English".	**Does not count** — try again

"Does not count" means no verdict, the question stays, your text stays editable, and your accuracy and mistakes are unchanged. An empty answer does nothing.

8.2 Meaning answers

Your answer and every accepted meaning are normalized before comparing:

- Upper/lower case is ignored; extra spaces are collapsed.
- Accents and full-width letters are simplified; hyphens and slashes count as spaces; other punctuation is ignored.
- Bracketed parts are optional: for "(one's) home", both "one's home" and "home" are accepted.
- A leading **"to"** is optional on both sides: "run" matches "to run", and "to eat" matches "eat".
- Numbers are exact: "3" is not "three", and "30 years old" is never close to "20 years old".
- Your own **synonyms** (chapter 9) are accepted exactly like built-in meanings.

Typo tolerance ("Close enough")

If nothing matches exactly, small typos are still accepted. The allowed number of edits (a letter inserted, deleted, changed, or two neighbors swapped) depends on the length of the accepted meaning:

Accepted meaning length	Edits allowed	Example
1–3 letters	0	"sun" must be exact
4–5 letters	1	"foru" → close for "four"
6–9 letters	2	"moutian" → close for "mountain"
10 or more	length ÷ 4, rounded down	12 letters → 3 edits

The course word guard

If what you typed is exactly the meaning of *another* item in the course, it is marked **wrong**, never "close". This stops a real but different word sneaking through as a typo (for example typing a neighboring kanji's meaning). A meaning shared by several items is still correct for each of them.

Typing Japanese (kana or kanji) into a meaning question is **invalid**: "Type the meaning in English".

8.3 Reading answers

- **Romaji becomes hiragana as you type**: typing `yama` gives やま. Type `nn` for a final ん. A Japanese keyboard works too. The helper line reads "Romaji turns into kana as you type. Press enter to check."
- **Katakana equals hiragana**: キュー is the same as きゅう, and half-width katakana works.
- **Long vowel marks** are expanded: typing `kyu-` gives きゅー, which equals きゅう.
- Spaces are ignored.
- **Kanji**: the answer must match a **primary** reading. If you type a valid reading of the *other* kind (kun'yomi when on'yomi is wanted, or the reverse), the field shakes with "Looking for the on'yomi" — it does not count against you.
- **Vocabulary**: any of the word's readings is accepted.
- Leftover romaji, digits, or symbols are **invalid**: "Type the reading in kana".

Accepted answers after a mistake

Meaning: every meaning, then your synonyms. Reading: the primary readings for a kanji; every reading for a word (primary first).

> **Reduced motion**
> If Android's "Remove animations" setting is on, the field does not shake, but the hint still appears and is announced by TalkBack.

9. Item pages, notes, synonyms, and audio

Tap any item chip or tile (in summaries, level pages, components lists) to open its **item page**. Every item has one — even locked ones.

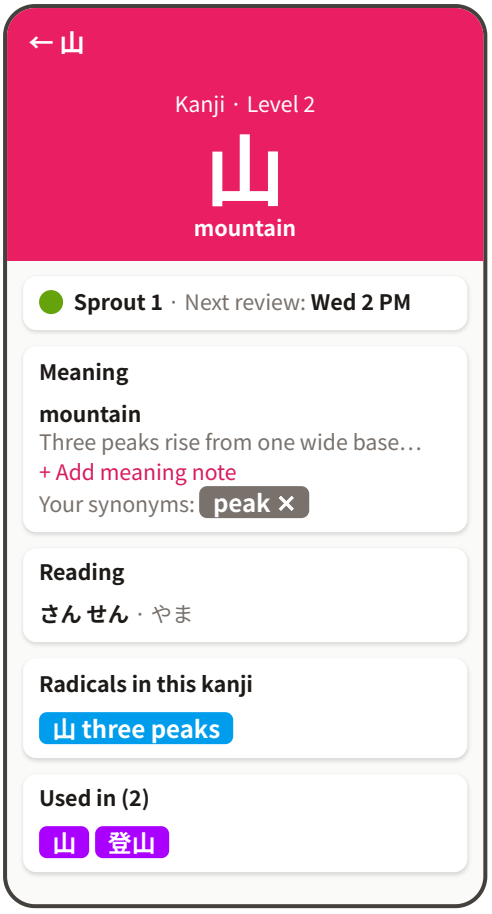


Figure 9.1 — An item page (illustration).

From top to bottom: hero band, stage strip, Meaning card, Reading card, components, and Used in.

9.1 What the page shows

- **Hero band** in the type color: type and level, the characters, the primary meaning.
- **Stage strip**: your stage and when the next review is.
- **Meaning card**: primary meaning, "Also accepted" meanings, the meaning mnemonic, your meaning note, and your synonyms.
- **Reading card** (kanji and words): readings with primary ones highlighted, the reading mnemonic, and your reading note. For words, a Play button.
- **Components**: "Radicals in this kanji" or "Kanji in this word", as chips with stage dots.
- **Used in (N)**: every item that uses this one — kanji for a radical, words for a kanji — ordered by level. Hidden when empty (always for words).

9.2 Next review text

Text	Meaning
Locked	Not unlocked yet.
Lesson ready	Waiting in the lesson queue.
Now	Due now.
in 25 min	Less than an hour away (rounded up).
in 5 h	Less than 24 hours away (whole hours).
Tomorrow 2 PM	On the next calendar day.
Wed 2 PM	Within the next 7 days.
Nov 20 / Nov 20, 2027	Further away (year shown when not this year).
Retired	Never comes back.

9.3 Your notes

Each item can hold a **meaning note** and a **reading note** — your own memory aids.

- Tap **Add meaning note** / **Add reading note**, or tap an existing note, to edit it in place. **Save** stores it; **Cancel** restores the saved text. Saving an empty field deletes the note.
- Up to **1000 characters**; a counter (e.g. "912 / 1000") appears past 900.
- Notes show on lesson pages under the mnemonics, and under "Show details" after a wrong answer.

9.4 Your synonyms

Synonyms are extra English meanings that the app will accept for this item — useful when you keep typing a word that means the same thing.

- Type in the field under "Your synonyms" and tap **Add**. Remove one with its ×. Changes save at once.
- 1–64 characters each, at most **8** per item.
- Refused with a reason under the field when: it contains Japanese ("Type an English meaning"), it has no letters or digits, it already matches a meaning or synonym ("Already accepted" — e.g. "run" when "to run" is a meaning), it is too long ("Use 64 characters or fewer"), or the item already has 8 ("You can add up to 8 synonyms").

> **When edits take effect**
> Lessons and reviews read your notes and synonyms when the session loads. An edit made during a session applies from the next session.

> **If a save fails**
> A toast says "Could not save. Try again." and nothing you typed is lost: the note stays open, the synonym stays in the field.

9.5 Audio for vocabulary

Vocabulary item pages and vocabulary lesson pages have a **Play** button next to the readings. It speaks the word's first primary reading using Android's built-in Japanese text-to-speech voice. Tapping while it speaks restarts it; leaving the screen stops it.

The button only appears if your phone has a Japanese voice. To add one: Android Settings → *System* → *Languages* → *Text-to-speech output* → your engine's settings → *Install voice data* → Japanese. Then restart the app.

10. The Levels tab and level pages

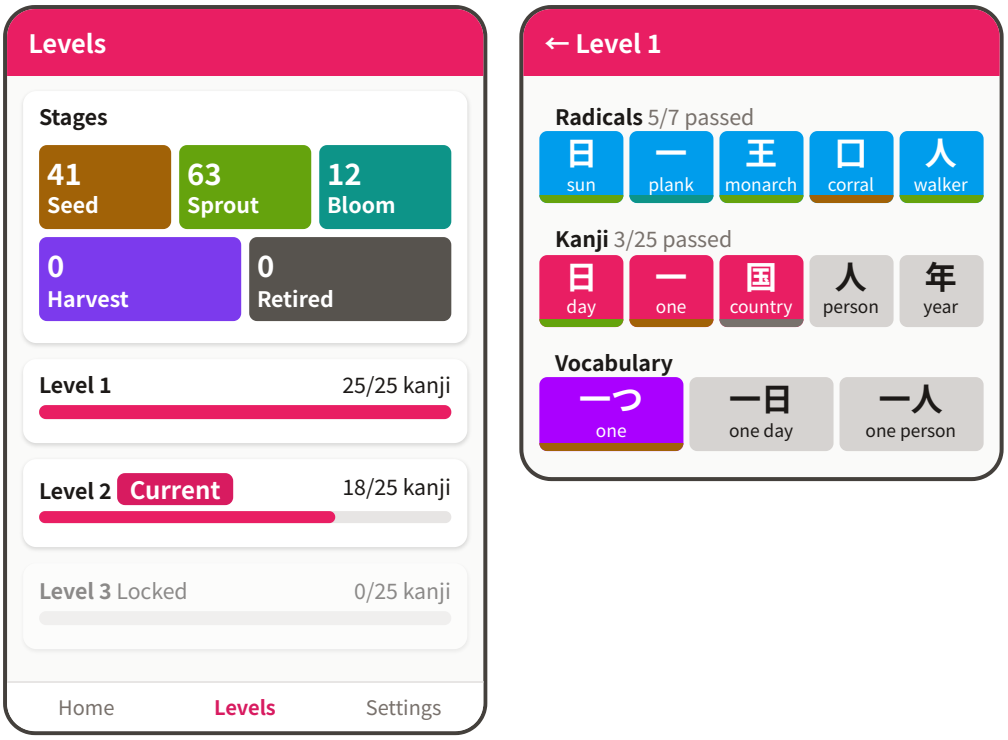


Figure 10.1 — Levels tab (left) and a level page (right). Illustration.

10.1 Levels tab

- At the top, the same five **stage tiles** as Home.
- Then one row per level: "Level N", kanji passed / total, and a kanji progress bar. Your current level has a **Current** badge. A level with no kanji shows "No kanji".
- Levels above your current level are greyed with **Locked**, but you can still open them to look ahead.
- Tap a row to open that level's page.

10.2 Level pages

A level page shows three sections — **Radicals**, **Kanji**, **Vocabulary** — each with "X/Y passed" and a grid of tiles in lesson order (5 per row for radicals and kanji, 3 for words).

Each tile has the type color, the characters, the primary meaning, and a **bar along the bottom in the stage color**. Items not unlocked yet are plain grey tiles with no bar. A legend under the grids names all seven states: Locked Lesson Seed Sprout Bloom Harvest Retired.

Tap any tile to open its item page.

11. Settings

The Settings tab has four cards: **Lessons**, **Reminders**, **Progress**, and **About**. Every change saves immediately — there is no Save button. If a save fails, a toast says "Could not save. Try again." and the control returns to its last saved value.

11.1 Lessons

Lessons per batch — a − / + stepper (default **5**, from **3** to **20**). The next lesson session you open uses the new size; a session already open keeps its size.

11.2 Reminders

Control	Default	What it does
Daily summary (switch)	On	One notification a day saying how many reviews are waiting.
Summary time	8:00 AM	When the daily summary arrives. Greyed while Daily summary is off.
Ping when reviews unlock (switch)	On	A notification when new reviews become due (at most one per hour).
Quiet from	10:00 PM	Start of quiet hours (no pings). Greyed while pings are off.
Quiet until	8:00 AM	End of quiet hours. Greyed while pings are off.

Tap a time row to open Android's time picker; **OK** saves, **Cancel** or back saves nothing. If quiet start equals quiet end, a line says "Same start and end: no quiet hours".

Notification permission row. If the app is not allowed to post notifications, this card shows why and a button:

- Not asked yet: "Allow notifications so reminders can show." → **Allow notifications** shows Android's permission prompt.
- Denied: "Notifications are off for this app, so reminders cannot show." → **Open Android settings** opens the app's system settings, where you can turn them on.

Turning a reminder switch on also asks for permission if needed. Once allowed, the row disappears.

11.3 Progress

Skip ahead

For learners who already know the early material. The card says "You are on level N" with a **Choose** button (or "You are on the highest level").

1. Tap **Choose**. The **Skip ahead** dialog opens with a level stepper starting at your level + 1.

2. Pick a level. A preview line updates: "X items below level N become Retired. They will not come up for review. You cannot undo this." (or "Nothing to retire. You move to level N.")
3. Confirm. Everything below that level becomes **Retired** (no reviews are written for them), your level is set, and the new level's radicals (and any eligible kanji and words) unlock for lessons. A toast says "Skipped to level L".

Skipping only moves forward — it never lowers your level or any stage. If the target level has no kanji, you can land one level higher automatically.

Reset all progress

Starts over from scratch. The dialog "Reset all progress?" explains: "Deletes all your progress, reviews, notes, and synonyms. Your settings stay. You cannot undo this. Type RESET to confirm." The confirm button stays disabled until you type `RESET` exactly. Afterwards you are back on level 1 with the level 1 radicals in your lesson queue, and a toast says "Progress reset".

> **Both actions are permanent**
> There is no undo and no backup. While either runs, the dialog cannot be dismissed, so a double tap cannot run it twice.

11.4 About

A **Credits and licenses** row opens the Credits screen (chapter 13). Below it a small line reads **"App X · content Y"**: the app version and the first 7 characters of the content version, useful when reporting a problem.

12. Review reminders (notifications)

The app sends **local** notifications — scheduled on the phone itself, with no server. They work offline.

12.1 The two kinds

	Daily summary	Due ping
Title	Reviews waiting	Reviews ready
Body	"N reviews waiting"	"N reviews are ready"
When	Once a day at your Summary time, for the next 7 days. Skipped today if the time has passed, and on any day with 0 reviews.	At the start of each hour in the next 24 hours when the due count rises above the last count notified. At most one per hour.
Quiet hours	Allowed (you chose the time)	Moved to the end of quiet hours

The count in every notification is the total number of reviews due at that moment. Tapping a notification opens **Reviews** if any are due, otherwise Home.

12.2 Quiet hours

No ping fires between **Quiet from** and **Quiet until**; the window can cross midnight (the default is 10 PM to 8 AM). A ping that would fall inside is moved to the end of quiet hours. If several pings land in the same hour they merge into one (with the latest count), and if a ping lands in the same hour as the daily summary, only the summary is sent.

12.3 Good to know

- Reminders are re-planned whenever you open the app, return to it, finish a lesson or review session, or change reminder settings — so counts stay accurate.
- Timing is **inexact** to save battery: Android may deliver a reminder some minutes late (up to about an hour on some phones).
- All reminders use one Android channel named **"Review reminders"**. You can change its sound or importance in Android's notification settings for the app.
- At most 31 reminders are scheduled at any time (7 daily + 24 pings).
- Changing time zones or a daylight saving change is handled automatically.

13. Credits and licenses

The **Credits** screen (Settings → About → Credits and licenses) lists every source the app is built from. Each card links to the source and its license, opening in your browser.

Source	By	License	Used for
JMdict	Electronic Dictionary Research and Development Group (EDRDG)	CC BY-SA 4.0	Word meanings and readings
KANJIDIC2	EDRDG	CC BY-SA 4.0	Kanji meanings, readings, frequency
KRADFILE	EDRDG	CC BY-SA 4.0	Kanji → radical components
jmdict-simplified	scriptin	CC BY-SA 4.0	JSON conversion of the above
JLPT N5–N3 kanji and vocab lists	Jonathan Waller (tanos.co.uk)	Creative Commons BY	Which kanji and words to teach
Noto Sans JP	Adobe / Google Fonts	SIL Open Font License 1.1	All app text
Material Design Icons	Pictogrammers	Apache License 2.0	Icons

Data was adapted: converted to JSON and filtered to the words and kanji this app teaches. **Radical names and mnemonics are original to this app.**

14. Display, accessibility, and navigation

- **Light and dark themes** follow your phone's system setting automatically, including the status and navigation bars.
- **Phone-first layout**: works from 360dp wide and with large font sizes (tested at 1.3× font scale). Tile text stops growing at 1.2× so grids stay readable.
- **Japanese text** is always rendered in Noto Sans JP, so it looks the same on every phone.
- **Keyboard-driven quizzes**: the keyboard opens on each question; enter checks, enter again continues.
- **Touch targets** are at least 48dp.
- **TalkBack**: every button, chip, tile, and stage tile has a spoken label, e.g. "kanji 大, large, Sprout" or "Seed, 41 items". Answer hints are announced as they appear.
- **Reduced motion**: with "Remove animations" on, the answer field does not shake.
- **Back button**: during a quiz or review session with answers in progress, back asks for confirmation (7.4). Elsewhere it behaves normally.
- **Errors**: any screen that fails to load shows a card with the message and `Try again`; failed saves show a toast and keep your input.

15. Troubleshooting and FAQ

The Lessons button is disabled.

Your lesson queue is empty. New items unlock as their parts reach Sprout 1 (stage 5) — for radicals that is about 3.5 days of correct reviews after the lesson. Keep doing reviews.

Why am I not leveling up?

You need 90% of the current level's kanji at Sprout 1 or higher. Check the Level card on Home: it tells you how many more kanji you need. Words do not count.

My correct answer was marked wrong.

Open the item page and add your answer as a **synonym**. It is accepted from the next session. If it is refused as "Already accepted", it differs only by something the checker ignores — check spelling. If your answer was the meaning of a different item, the course word guard rejects it on purpose.

The reading field says "Looking for the on'yomi".

You typed a correct reading of the wrong kind for this kanji. It does not count against you; type the other kind.

I cannot type ん.

Type `nn` (or `n'`) so the converter knows the n stands alone.

There is no Play button on vocabulary.

Your phone has no Japanese text-to-speech voice. Install one (see 9.5) and restart the app.

I am not getting reminders.

- Check Settings → Reminders: is the switch on, and is there a permission row? Use it to allow notifications.
- Check Android's settings for the app: the "Review reminders" channel must be enabled.
- Pings never fire during quiet hours, and nothing fires when nothing is due.
- Some phones' battery savers delay or block scheduled notifications; exclude the app from battery optimization.
- Open the app once — every open re-plans the reminders.

Will an update erase my progress?

No. Installing a newer APK over the old one keeps everything. Content updates only add or refresh items; item ids never change, so progress always stays attached to the right item.

Can I back up or move my progress to a new phone?

Not yet. Progress lives only on this phone. Uninstalling the app or clearing its storage deletes it.

I skipped ahead too far.

Skip ahead cannot be undone, and it never moves you down. The only way back is **Reset all progress**, which starts over at level 1.

The app shows an error screen at launch.

A database upgrade failed. The screen shows the message; nothing has been deleted. Note the message and the "App X · content Y" line if you can, and install a fixed APK.

Appendix A. Quick reference cards

A.1 Stages at a glance

Stage	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Name	Seed 1	Seed 2	Seed 3	Seed 4	Sprout 1	Sprout 2	Bloom	Harvest	Retired
Wait	4 h	8 h	1 d	2 d	1 wk	2 wk	30 d	120 d	—
Total from lesson*	0	4 h	12 h	~1.5 d	~3.5 d	~10.5 d	~24.5 d	~54.5 d	~174.5 d

* Earliest time to reach the stage with no mistakes, reviewing as soon as due (ignoring hour rounding).

A.2 Stage change rule

No mistakes → stage + 1. Mistakes → stage − ceil(wrong ÷ 2) × (2 if stage ≥ 5 else 1), minimum 1.

A.3 Unlock rules

Radical: its level reached · Kanji: all its radicals ≥ stage 5 · Word: all its kanji ≥ stage 5 · Level up: ≥ 90% of the level's kanji ≥ stage 5.

A.4 Answer cheat sheet

You type	Result
`Mountain!` for "mountain"	Correct (case and punctuation ignored)
`eat` for "to eat"	Correct (leading "to" optional)
`moutian` for "mountain"	Close enough
`3` for "three"	Wrong (numbers are exact)
`やま` in a meaning question	Invalid — "Type the meaning in English"
`yama` → やま for kanji 山 (on'yomi wanted)	Wrong kind — "Looking for the on'yomi"
`san` → さん for kanji 山	Correct
サン (katakana)	Correct (katakana = hiragana)
`sa` + leftover letters, e.g. さx	Invalid — "Type the reading in kana"

A.5 Limits and defaults

Setting / limit	Value
Lessons per batch	5 (3–20)
Review items in play	10
Daily summary / time	On / 8:00 AM
Due pings / quiet hours	On / 10:00 PM – 8:00 AM
Note length	1000 characters
Synonyms	8 per item, 64 characters each
Level up threshold	90% of the level's kanji passed

Appendix B. For the builder: content pipeline and test tools

This appendix is for whoever builds the app from source. Regular users can skip it.

B.1 Running and building

Command	Purpose
`npm run dev`	Start the Expo dev server; open in Expo Go (`npx expo start --tunnel` if a firewall blocks the phone).
`npm test`	Vitest unit tests, including content validation.
`npx eas-cli@latest build -p android --profile preview`	Build a sideloadable APK. Profile `e2e` adds the debug clock for Maestro tests.
`npm run test:e2e`	Run the Maestro flows in `maestro/` against the e2e APK.
`npm run db:generate`	Create a new SQL migration after a schema change (runs on app launch).

B.2 Content pipeline

Command	Purpose
`npm run pipeline:download`	Fetch the pinned open data into `pipeline/raw/`, recording URL, date, SHA-256, and license.
`npm run pipeline:build`	Select N5–N3 kanji and words, build levels, assign stable ids → `content/subjects.json`.
`npm run pipeline:batch -- --levels 1-3`	Write batches of up to 25 items that still need mnemonics.
`npm run pipeline:merge`	Validate filled batches and merge them into `content/mnemonics/`.
`npm run pipeline:validate`	Run all content rules.
`npm run pipeline:bundle`	Merge enabled levels and mnemonics into `content/bundle.json` and write `content-version.txt`; the app reseeds on launch when it changes.

Validation fails when, among others: an item appears before one of its parts; a kanji or word has no meaning or reading; an enabled item has no mnemonic; a kanji meaning story does not name every one of its radicals or is not 2–4 sentences; two radicals share a name; or an id changed. Ids are never renumbered or reused — items that drop out are recorded in `content/retired.json`.

B.3 Debug clock (development and e2e builds only)

Development and `e2e` builds show a **Developer** card at the bottom of Home with a **`Debug clock`** button. The debug clock screen shows the current (shifted) time, buttons to **move time forward** by a number of hours, **`Reset`**, and a **Progress shortcut** "Move level N to stage 4" that makes the current level's items due at Seed 4 so one correct review passes them. In the release (`preview`) APK these screens do not exist and their links go to Home.

B.4 Ground rules for contributors

- No content, names, or API from any paid course — ever. Radical names and mnemonics are original.
- Only the data sources listed in chapter 13; any new one must be recorded with its license and credited.
- App code never writes to content tables; content changes only through the pipeline and reseed.
- The SRS, answer, and reminder logic stay pure functions with the time passed in.

Appendix C. Glossary

Term	Meaning
SRS	Spaced repetition system: reviews at growing intervals, timed to just before you would forget.
Subject / item	One radical, kanji, or word.
Radical	A building-block shape inside kanji, given an original English name in this app.
On'yomi	A kanji's Chinese-derived reading, usually used in compound words (e.g. 山 → さん).
Kun'yomi	A kanji's native Japanese reading, often used when the kanji stands alone (e.g. 山 → やま).
Primary reading / meaning	The reading(s) or meaning a question expects; others may be shown as "also accepted".
Rendaku	A sound change where the second part of a compound gains voicing (e.g. か → が).
Mnemonic	A short memory story for an item's meaning or reading.
Sound hook	A fixed English word used for the same reading across all reading mnemonics.
Lesson queue	Unlocked items (stage 0) waiting to be learned.
Passed	At stage 5 (Sprout 1) or higher. Unlocks dependent items.
Retired	Stage 9: never reviewed again.
Synonym	Your own extra accepted English meaning for an item.
Wrap up	Finish only the review items already in play.
Skip ahead	Jump to a higher level, retiring everything below it.
Quiet hours	The daily window when due pings are held back.
JLPT	Japanese-Language Proficiency Test; N5 is the easiest level, N1 the hardest.
APK	An Android app install file.